the default Program.cs file. The `WebApplication` is the core of your ASP.NET Core application, containing the application configuration and the Kestrel server that listens for requests and sends responses.

Listing 3.3 The default Program.cs file that configures and runs a `WebApplication`

```
WebApplicationBuilder builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);  ❶
WebApplication app = builder.Build();                                ❷

app.MapGet("/", () => "Hello World!");                               ❸

app.Run();                                                           ❹
```

❶ Creates a WebApplicationBuilder using the CreateBuilder method

❷ Builds and returns an instance of WebApplication from the WebApplicationBuilder

❸ Defines an endpoint for your application, which returns Hello World! when the path "/" is called

❹ Runs the WebApplication to start listening for requests and generating responses

These four lines contain all the initialization code you need to create a web server and start listening for requests. It uses a `WebApplicationBuilder`, created by the call to `CreateBuilder`, to define how the `WebApplication` is configured, before instantiating the `WebApplication` with a call to `Build()`.

NOTE You'll find this pattern of using a builder object to configure a complex object repeated throughout the ASP.NET Core framework. This technique is useful for allowing users to configure an object, delaying its creation until all configuration has finished. It's also one of the patterns described in the "Gang of Four" book *Design Patterns: Elements of Reusable Object-Oriented Software*, by Erich Gamma, Richard Helm, Ralph Johnson, and John Vlissides (Addison-Wesley, 1994).

In this simple application we don't make any changes to `WebApplicationBuilder` before calling `Build()`, but